Additionally, the data product Locator exposes its API externally. The analysts can keep on working with DataHub, but the ML engineers could use the new interface to programmatically keep track of the location of the data products Team Gray provides.

Federated computational governance in iteration 2

Now that the data can be stored outside the central Git repository, the federated aspect of governance becomes increasingly important. The Data team decides to provide some small additional capabilities inside its Terraform template. The team members implement a simple endpoint that provides data about the state of the data product, including the recency of the data, the size, and basic data classification on a column level.

Storage outside the central Git repository also rips open another topic: access policies. In a federated fashion, Messflix could simply decide to let the data producers handle everything on their own. To implement that, Messflix should provide a default "restrict everything" policy for the PostgreSQL instance. In detail, the company would provide a read-only role and group that is essentially able to retrieve only metadata and not even data. This would be used for lineage calculation and listing of datasets, possibly enriching the DataHub.

However, the team chooses to provide a little bit more help to data-producing teams. Right now, there are only two, so they choose to provide two default policies. One is a "restricted access" role. It should be used by teams to mark datasets inside data products as sensitive. The second role is an "open for all" role that is supposed to be used to mark datasets inside data products as open to everyone at Messflix. The company decides to leave the rest of the policy management up to the data-producing teams for now, until the federated governance body provides more guidance.

Finally, we want to take another look at the data producers—this time, all of them. Now that the flow on the data consumer side isn't the bottleneck anymore, the focus should be on enabling the data producers, as we'll see in the next section.